



THE BUDGET MAKERS

(From left) **T.V. Somanathan**, Finance Secretary

Sanjay Malhotra, Secretary, Department of Revenue

Tuhin Kanta Pandey, Secretary, Department of Investment and Public Asset Management

» The government has set a realistic growth target; the global economic environment is not conducive for a 10 per cent GDP growth rate like in the past

» Increase in customs duty is a tool that has been used by many countries like Japan and Korea in the past, who are now global powerhouses

» The government is confident about achieving its ambitious ₹10-lakh crore capital expenditure target for the

next financial year

» The government is on course to spend ₹7.3 lakh crore (out of the ₹7.5 lakh crore Budget Estimate) in FY23; the shortfall is due to some states not being able to utilise the funds initially planned

» The current economic realities dictate that the fiscal deficit may remain higher than the FRBM (Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management) target of 3 per cent



domestic investor, which makes it unattractive for domestic investors to invest in start-ups

» The start-up ecosystem has been asking for the easing out of angel tax but that has not come through. Access to money is essential for the start-up sector and investments from angels play an important role in that



A BUDGET FOR THE WORKFORCE

Dharmendra Pradhan, Minister of Education

» The education sector has received the highest allocation of ₹1.25 lakh crore in post-independent India

» The ministries of Education; Health and Family Welfare; Electronics and IT; and the departments of Science & Technology; and Space will be spending a substantial sum on both skilling and education of

around 300 million students

» The National Education Policy, 2020, is expected to help create citizens with a global mindset who not only solve the country's problems but also complement the global workforce

» ₹9,000 crore has been allocated towards skilling to create a robust MSME ecosystem